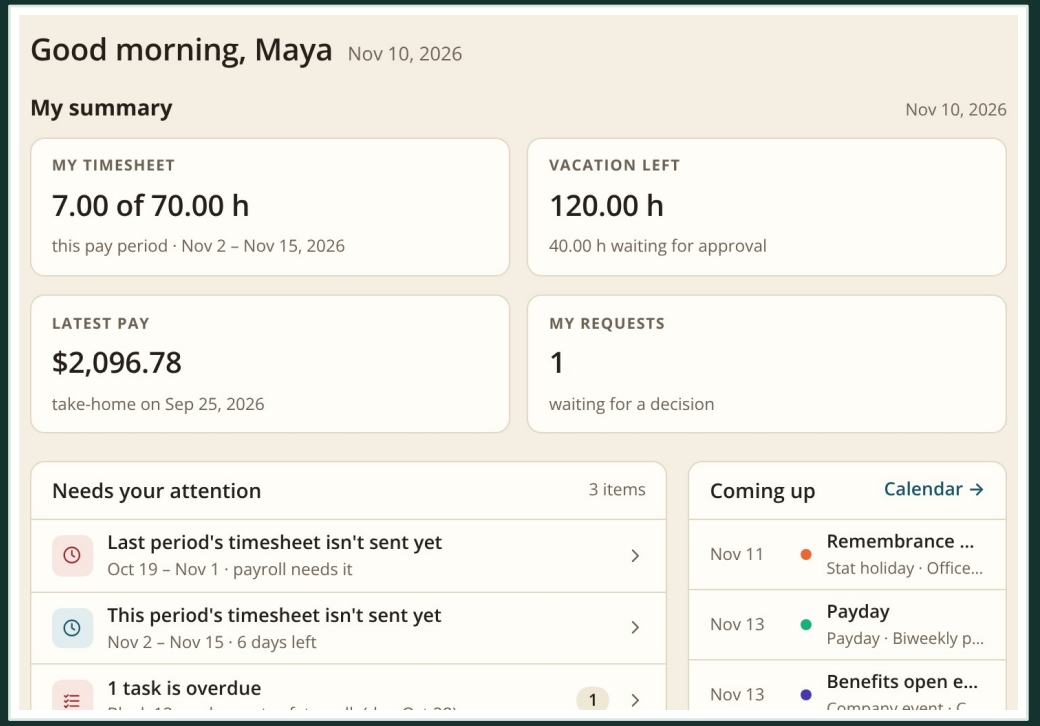
One place for requests, purchase orders, timesheets and tasks

A working prototype, and what it would save

Briefing for the Executive Committee · November 2026



Prepared by Andalib Olee

The proposal in one minute

Today requests, purchase orders and timesheets run on paper and PDF forms, signatures, scans and email, and there is no shared place for tasks. One central system would handle all four, with every approval recorded automatically.

≈ 1/3

of the task time: a request, purchase order or timesheet takes about one third of the time it takes today

≈ 1,400 h

a year given back to real work, for every 100 staff

≈ $56,000

a year in staff time, at $40 an hour

No hunting

for a missing form or PO: every one has a number, a status and its approvals on record

How these were estimated

- An organization of 100 staff at $40 an hour: 2,600 timesheets a year (one every two weeks each), about 600 requests and 240 purchase orders.
- Task time today: 1–2 hours for a request or purchase order (filling in or editing the PDF, signatures, scanning, emailing, following up) and about 20 minutes for a timesheet. In the system: about one third of that.
- The yearly counts are assumptions; CHN's own counts would give CHN's figure. The cost to build and host the live system is not counted.

Today a purchase order travels by paper, scanner and email

TODAY: paper, signatures, scanner and email

1 A paper PO form is filled in by hand › 2 It is taken round for signatures › 3 Someone scans it › 4 The scan is sent to Finance; the department keeps one copy › 5 Finance stores it on a computer › 6 Later it has to be hunted for. Sometimes it is missing

WITH THE SYSTEM: one place

1 It is filled in online › 2 The supervisor approves with one click › 3 Director level approves if it is over $5,000 › 4 The PO is numbered and stays on record

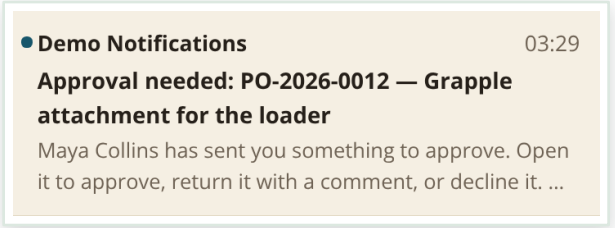
Pages printed

about 3 → 0

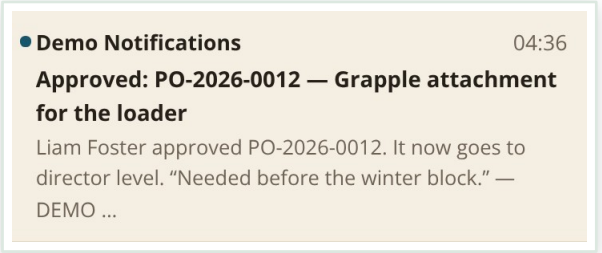
Missing purchase orders

sometimes → none

Nobody writes an email. The system sends the notices itself:

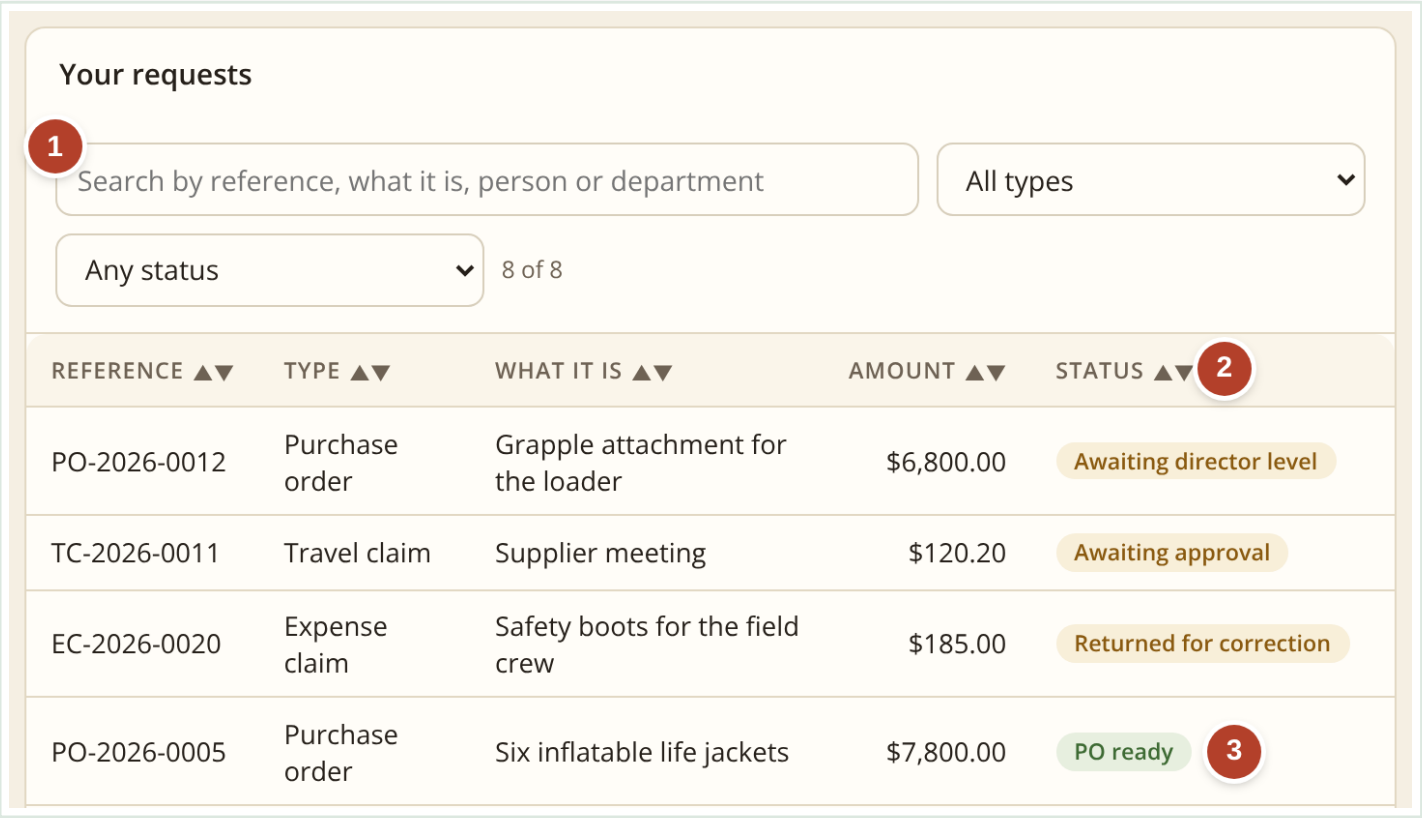


The supervisor receives this



The employee receives this

Requests: every type in one place, with its status



Screen: My requests, as an employee sees it.

Today: a paper or PDF form for each type, saved and passed on as an email attachment. To know where one is, you ask around.

1 **Find any request in seconds**
Search by number, person, department or what it was for.

2 **See where it stands right now**
Awaiting approval, awaiting director level, returned to you, or ready.

3 **Nothing goes missing**
A finished request stays on the list with its number. It cannot be lost in an inbox or a filing tray.

Five request types, one short form each: travel, credit card purchase, travel claim, expense claim and purchase order.

Five kinds of request, each with its files and its history

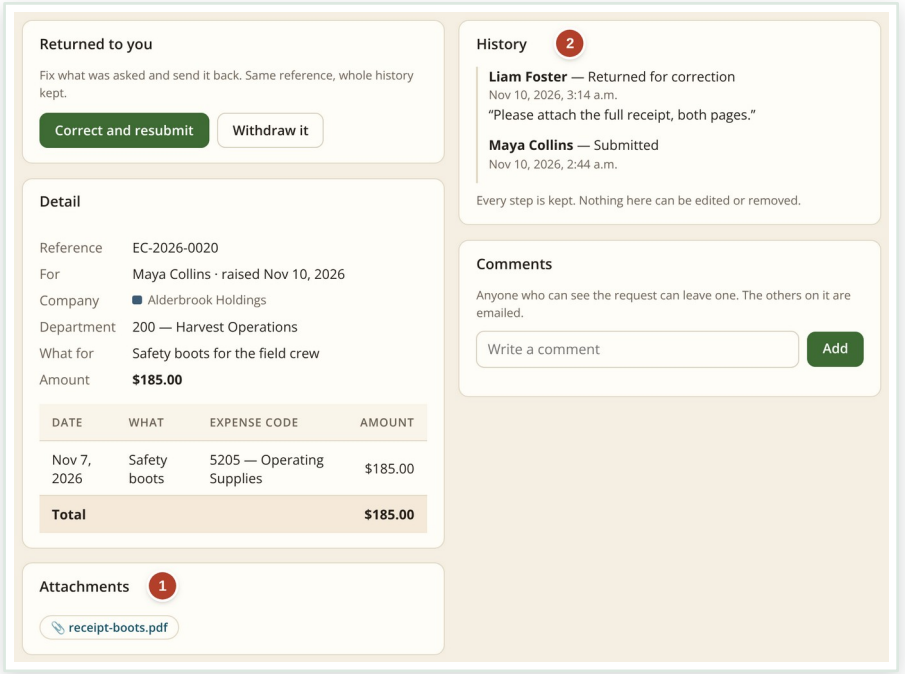
Travel request
Approval before a trip: where, when and the estimated cost.

Credit card purchase
Approval before buying something on the organization's card.

Travel claim
Mileage, meals and other costs after a trip.

Expense claim
Money spent out of pocket, with the receipt.

Purchase order
Approval to order from a supplier.



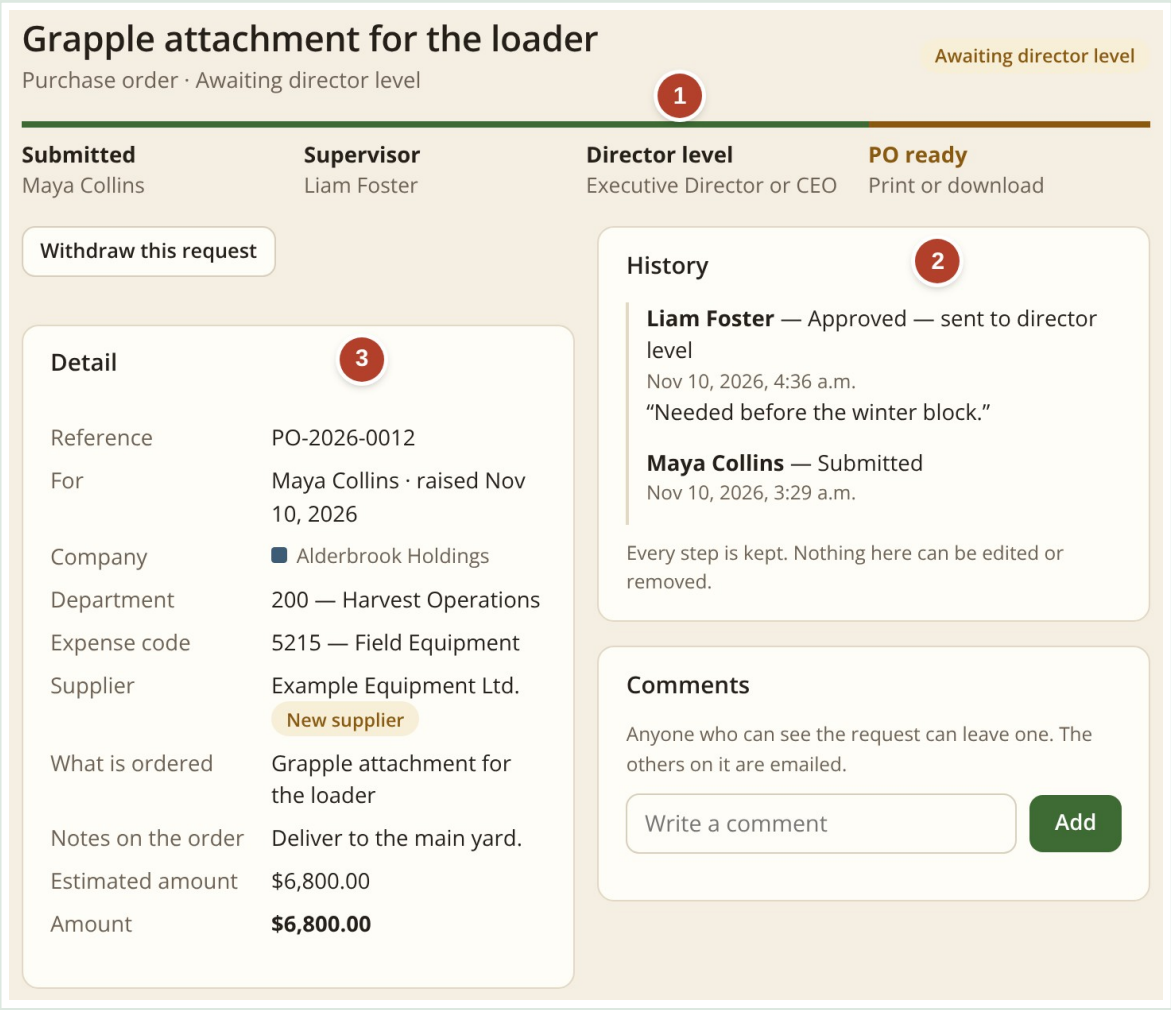
Screen: one expense claim opened.

1 Files attached
Receipts, quotes and other files are added while filling in the request. They stay with it.

2 Its own history
Who sent it, who approved or returned it, when, and any comment.

A proper audit trail for every type. The request, its files and each approval are kept together under one number. Nothing can be edited or removed.

A request moves in minutes, and everyone can see it



Screen: one request opened. The bar shows the route.

1 The route
Who has approved and who is next.

2 The history
Each step with name, date and comment.

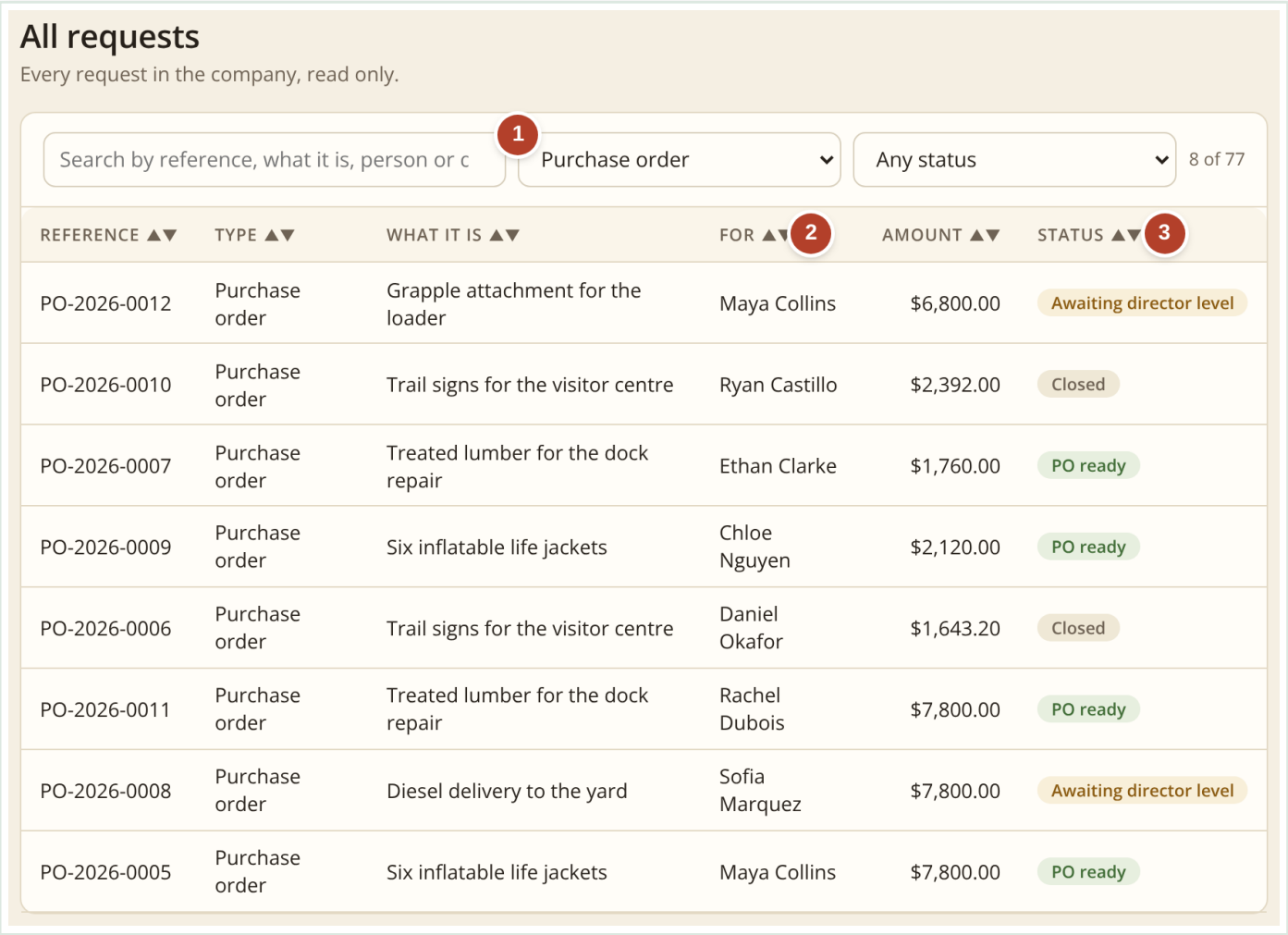
3 The details
Department and expense code are required.

	TODAY	NEW SYSTEM
Steps people do	6	2
Emails written	≈ 3	0
Time per request	1–2 hours	≈ 30 min
Signatures	hand or e-sign	one click

Estimates for an organization of 100 staff; how they were estimated is on slide 2.

Working prototype · fictional demo data · figures are estimates

Purchase orders: one list shows where every order stands



All requests

Every request in the company, read only.

Search by reference, what it is, person or c | Purchase order | Any status | 8 of 77

REFERENCE	TYPE	WHAT IT IS	FOR	AMOUNT	STATUS
PO-2026-0012	Purchase order	Grapple attachment for the loader	Maya Collins	$6,800.00	Awaiting director level
PO-2026-0010	Purchase order	Trail signs for the visitor centre	Ryan Castillo	$2,392.00	Closed
PO-2026-0007	Purchase order	Treated lumber for the dock repair	Ethan Clarke	$1,760.00	PO ready
PO-2026-0009	Purchase order	Six inflatable life jackets	Chloe Nguyen	$2,120.00	PO ready
PO-2026-0006	Purchase order	Trail signs for the visitor centre	Daniel Okafor	$1,643.20	Closed
PO-2026-0011	Purchase order	Treated lumber for the dock repair	Rachel Dubois	$7,800.00	PO ready
PO-2026-0008	Purchase order	Diesel delivery to the yard	Sofia Marquez	$7,800.00	Awaiting director level
PO-2026-0005	Purchase order	Six inflatable life jackets	Maya Collins	$7,800.00	PO ready

Screen: Requests › All requests, showing purchase orders only.

1 Every purchase order in one list
Each has its own number. Pick “Purchase order” and they are all there.

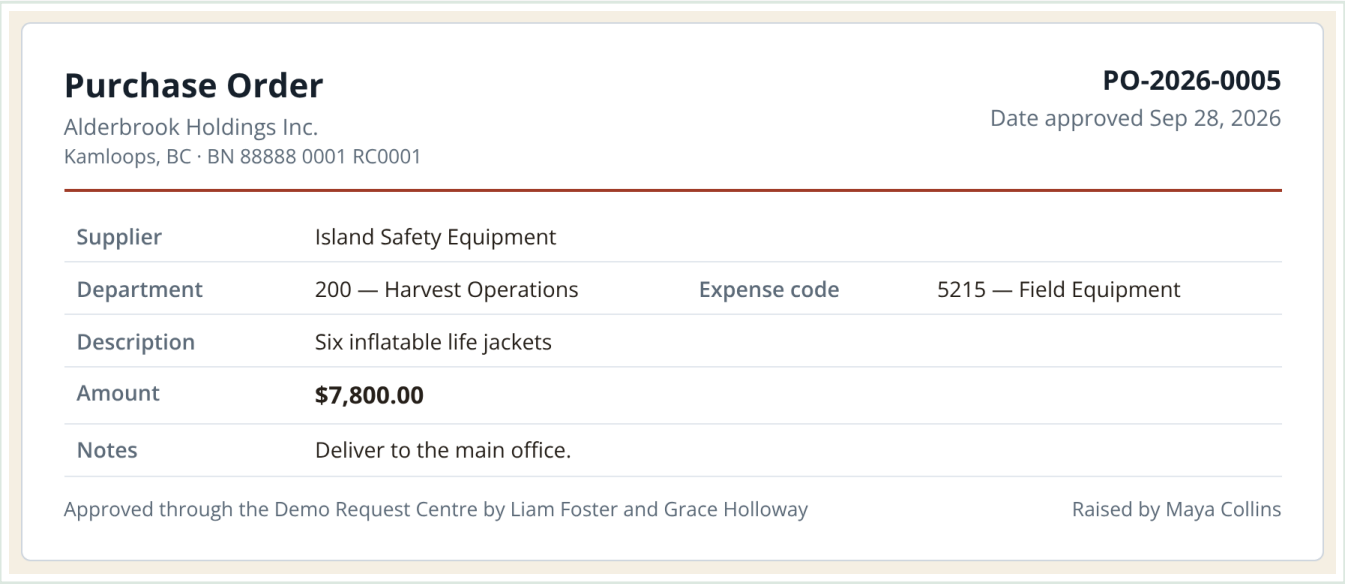
2 Who asked for it
The person and what was ordered, with the amount.

3 Where it stands
Awaiting director level, PO ready, or closed.

Today: to find a PO, someone searches paper files, scans and inboxes, and sometimes it is not there.

Working prototype · fictional demo data · figures are estimates

Proper approval every time, and no missing POs



Purchase Order

Alderbrook Holdings Inc.
Kamloops, BC · BN 88888 0001 RC0001

PO-2026-0005
Date approved Sep 28, 2026

Supplier	Island Safety Equipment		
Department	200 — Harvest Operations	Expense code	5215 — Field Equipment
Description	Six inflatable life jackets		
Amount	**$7,800.00**		
Notes	Deliver to the main office.		

Approved through the Demo Request Centre by Liam Foster and Grace Holloway

Raised by Maya Collins

Screen: the one-page purchase order, ready to print or download as a PDF.

Employee asks → Supervisor approves → Director level if over $5,000 → **PO is ready, with its number**

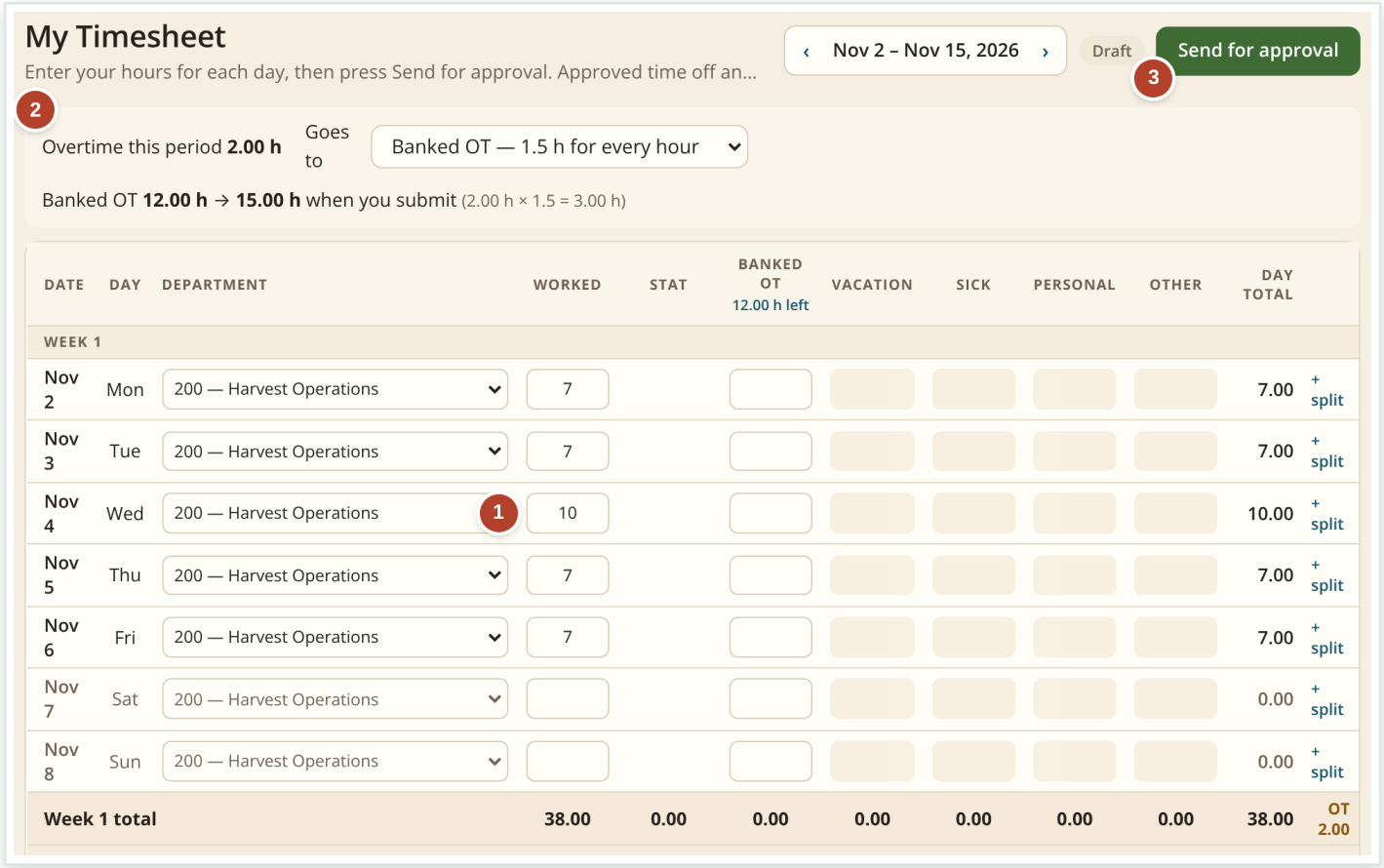
What changes for one purchase order

	TODAY	NEW SYSTEM
Steps people do	8	3
Time per order	1–2 hours	≈ 30 min
Pages printed	≈ 3	0 to 1
Missing POs	sometimes	none

The approval is always complete. Nobody approves their own order and no level can be skipped. The PO shows who approved it, so the printed order always matches what was approved.

Estimates for an organization of 100 staff; how they were estimated is on slide 2.

Timesheets: type the hours, the system does the math



Screen: My Timesheet, as an employee sees it.

Today: a paper or spreadsheet timesheet, signed, scanned and emailed. Overtime and banked time are counted by hand.

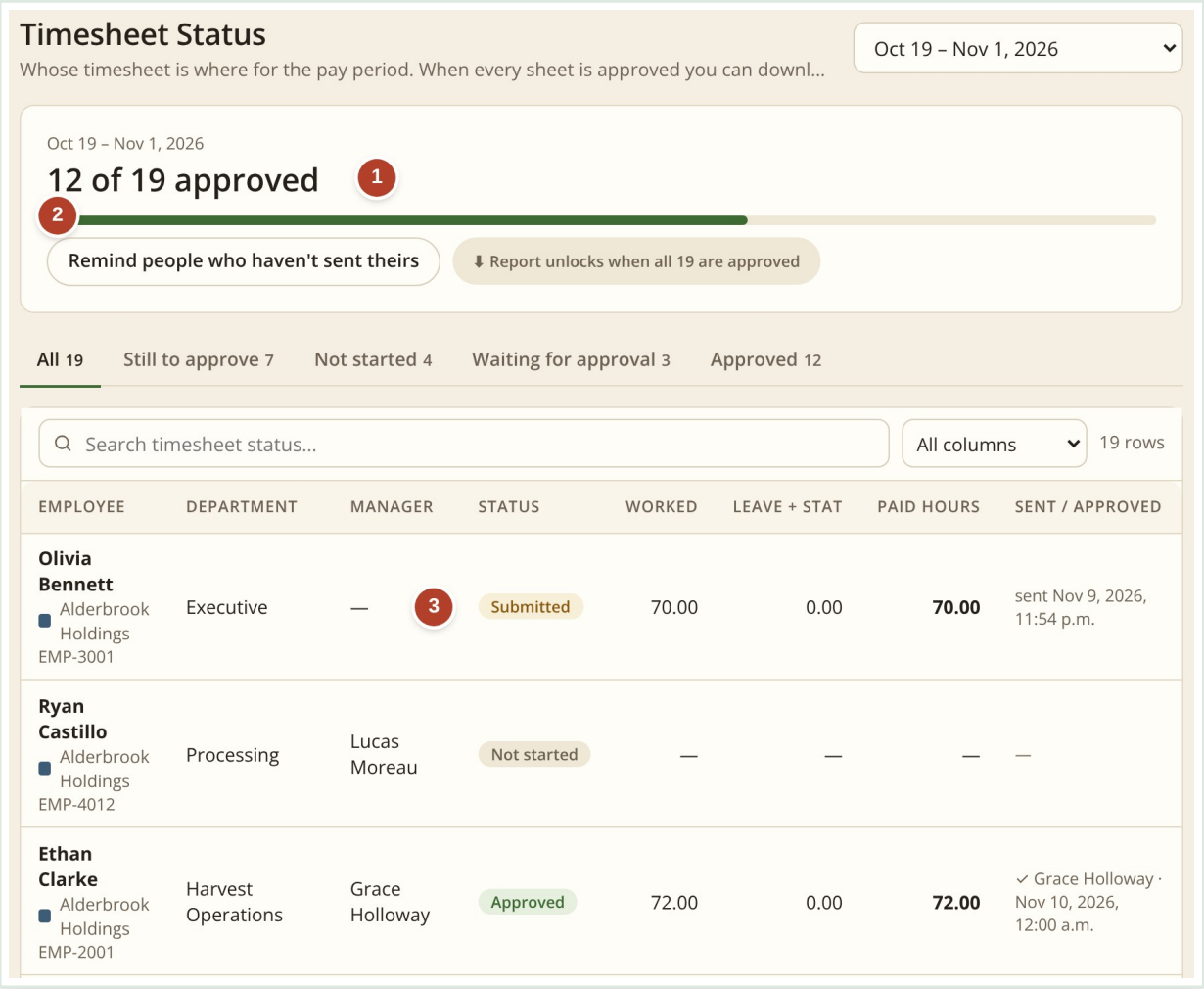
1 Type the hours for each day
Here a 10-hour Wednesday among 7-hour days.

2 Overtime is worked out for you
Banked at 1.5 hours for every hour, or paid: the employee chooses. The balance updates at once.

3 One button sends it for approval
The supervisor approves it on screen. No paper, no scan.

Stat holidays and approved time off fill in by themselves.

One page shows who has not sent a timesheet



Screen: Time & Attendance › By pay period.

1 Progress for the pay period
How many timesheets are approved.

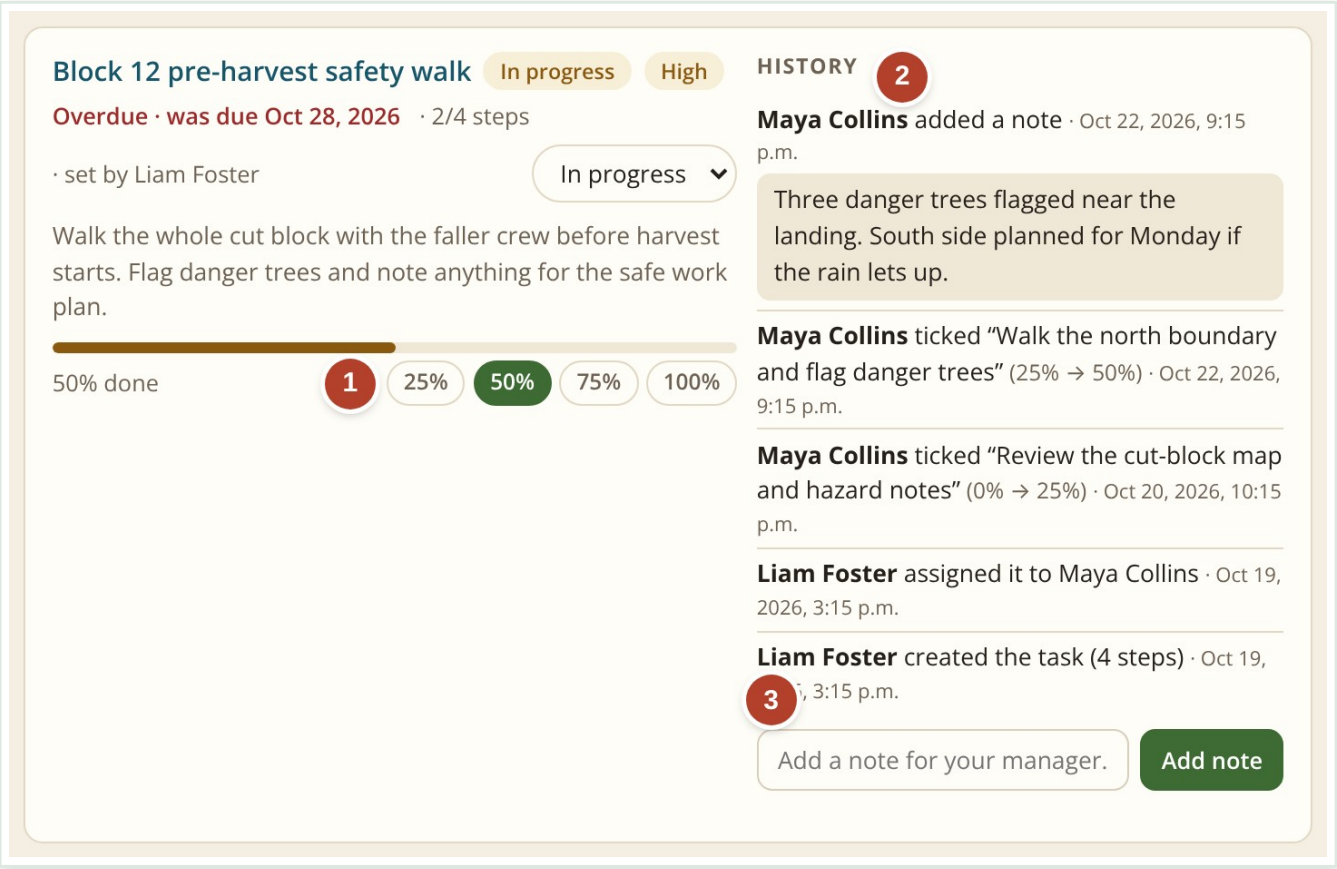
2 One button reminds the rest
No chasing by email or phone.

3 Each person's status
Not started, submitted or approved.

	TODAY	NEW SYSTEM
Steps people do	5	2
Time per timesheet	≈ 20 min	≈ 7 min
Overtime, banked time	by hand	automatic
Chasing late ones	one by one	one button

Estimates for an organization of 100 staff; how they were estimated is on slide 2.

My Tasks: assigned, tracked and reported in one place



Screen: My Tasks. One task a manager assigned to an employee.

1. **Progress with one click**
   25, 50, 75 or 100 percent.

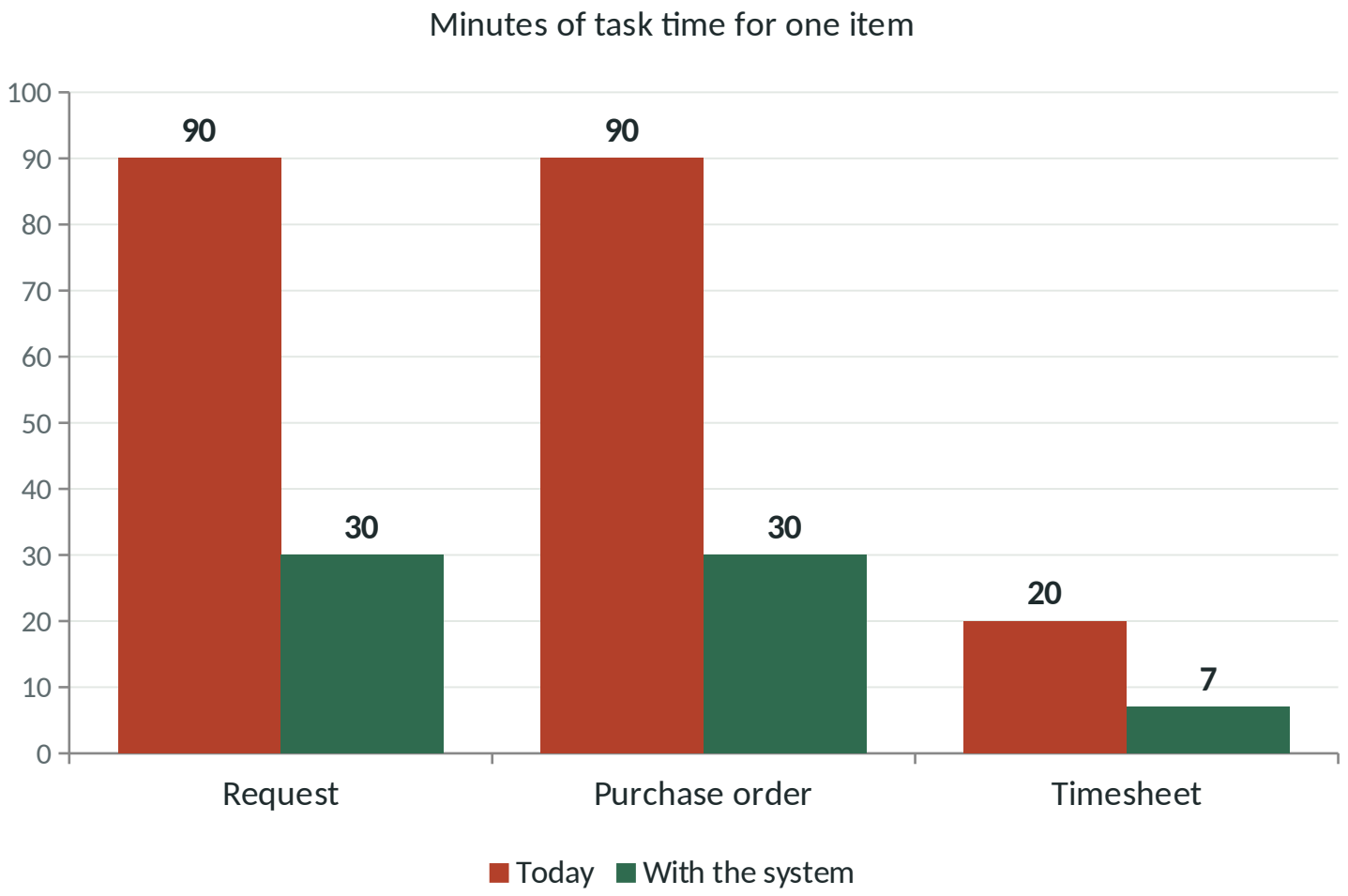
2. **The history**
   Who did what, and when.

3. **A note for the manager**
   It replaces the status email.

Today: nothing like this. Tasks are given by email or in a meeting, and progress is found out by asking.

A streamlined workflow and more productive teams. Everyone sees what is assigned, what is late and what is done.

Task time drops to about one third



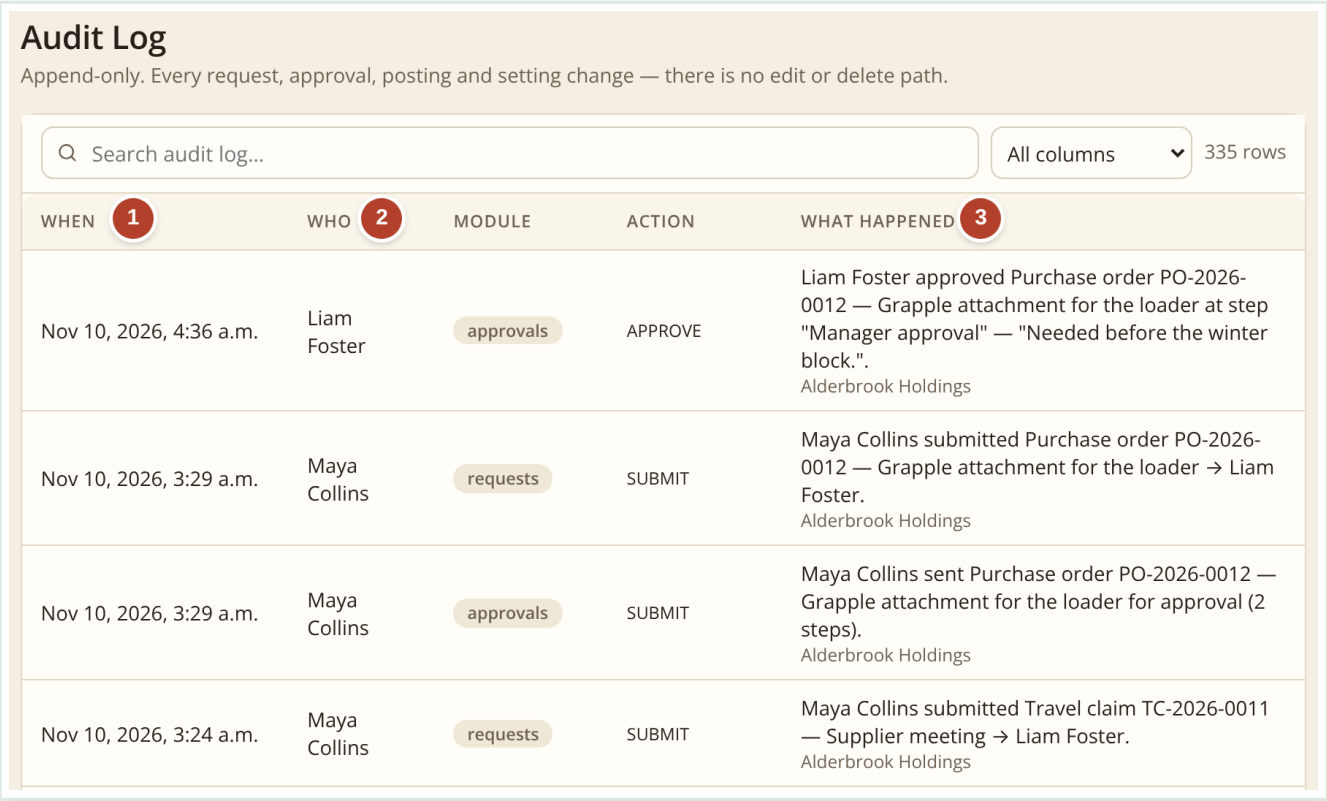
Where the time goes today

- Filling in paper forms or editing PDFs, and collecting signatures.
- Scanning and emailing the signed copy.
- Hunting for a form or PO that cannot be found.
- Counting overtime, banked time and leave by hand.

The system removes these four. It does not remove the decision: a person still approves every item.

Estimates for an organization of 100 staff; how they were estimated is on slide 2.

A proper audit trail, kept automatically



Audit Log

Append-only. Every request, approval, posting and setting change — there is no edit or delete path.

Search audit log...

All columns

335 rows

WHEN 1	WHO 2	MODULE	ACTION	WHAT HAPPENED 3
Nov 10, 2026, 4:36 a.m.	Liam Foster	approvals	APPROVE	Liam Foster approved Purchase order PO-2026-0012 — Grapple attachment for the loader at step "Manager approval" — "Needed before the winter block.". Alderbrook Holdings
Nov 10, 2026, 3:29 a.m.	Maya Collins	requests	SUBMIT	Maya Collins submitted Purchase order PO-2026-0012 — Grapple attachment for the loader → Liam Foster. Alderbrook Holdings
Nov 10, 2026, 3:29 a.m.	Maya Collins	approvals	SUBMIT	Maya Collins sent Purchase order PO-2026-0012 — Grapple attachment for the loader for approval (2 steps). Alderbrook Holdings
Nov 10, 2026, 3:24 a.m.	Maya Collins	requests	SUBMIT	Maya Collins submitted Travel claim TC-2026-0011 — Supplier meeting → Liam Foster. Alderbrook Holdings

Screen: Administration › Audit log. One purchase order, step by step.

Today: the trail is paper forms, scans and emails spread across folders and inboxes. If a PO is missing, so is the proof of its approval. **With the system:** one searchable record, ready for auditors and funders.

1 When
The date and time of every action, written the moment it happens.

2 Who
The person who did it, by name.

3 What happened
In plain words, with the request number, the step and any comment.

Nothing can be edited or deleted. A request can only be returned, declined or closed, and that is recorded too.

Beyond time saved: independence and less stress



Less dependence on outside apps

Requests, purchase orders, timesheets and tasks live in one system instead of separate tools, spreadsheets and paper forms. Fewer subscriptions, fewer logins.



No dependence on AI

The system runs on fixed, ordinary rules that people set. It needs no AI service to work, and no information is sent to one.



CHN’s own data storage

Records are kept in one central database that CHN owns and controls. CHN chooses where it is hosted: its own servers or a host in Canada.



Less paperwork, less stress

No forms to print, sign and scan. No hunting for a missing PO. Everyone can see where things stand, so nothing is lost or forgotten.

Where we are, and what happens next

Today: a working prototype

Every screen in this briefing is real and can be tried in a browser, with fictional people and figures. It is not yet connected to real staff accounts or email.

Time to build the live system

About 1 to 2 months, in stages, with a small team. This is an early estimate, to be confirmed with IT.

Decision requested: approve steps 1 and 2.

1. **Confirm the numbers**
   Replace the estimates with CHN's own counts of requests, purchase orders and timesheets.
2. **Pilot with one or two departments**
   Start with purchase orders and timesheets, where paper causes the most trouble.
3. **Decide hosting and sign-in with IT**
   CHN's own servers or a host in Canada; staff use their existing work accounts.
4. **Build in stages and test with real users**
   Go live after the pilot departments have used it for full pay periods.